

Care Up Kerala: A Real Time Medical Companion and NRI Presence Bridge

Introduction

Kerala's healthcare system follows a unique bystander model, where hospitals expect a family member to manage essential non-medical tasks such as pharmacy runs, laboratory submissions, file handling, and assisting during doctor consultations. This creates a major gap for elderly patients whose children live abroad, especially in the US, UK, and Gulf countries.

While Western systems rely on nurses for these responsibilities, Kerala's model unintentionally leaves many elderly parents struggling during hospital visits and admissions. Their NRI child experiences constant anxiety, guilt, and helplessness, often making multiple daily calls just to understand what the doctor said

Care up solves this problem by providing a hyper-local medical companion marketplace. It acts not just as a medical helper but as a Presence Bridge between NRI families and their loved ones in Kerala. The platform connects NRIs with verified companions who can physically be with their parents during hospital visits and support tasks

MVP Components

1. Request Portal (NRI-Facing)

A simplified booking interface where users select:

- . Hospital
- . Date & time
- . Type of assistance needed

Support options include general help, pharmacy/lab runs, or attending doctor consultations. The portal minimizes steps and reduces friction, especially helpful for NRIs dealing with time-zone differences.

2. Verified Companion Network

A curated pool of:

- . MSW students
- . Nursing interns
- . Trained volunteers

Every companion undergoes:

- . ID verification
- . Background check
- . Brief medical-support training

This ensures safety, reliability, and dignity for elderly patients

3. Live Care Feed (Signature Feature)

A private, real-time activity timeline where companions send:

- . Short messages
- . Time-stamped notes
- . Optional photos

Example updates:

- . 9:15 AM: "Checked in. Patient settled."
- . 10:30 AM: "Doctor consulted. New medication prescribed."
- . 10:45 AM: "Purchased medicines from hospital pharmacy."

This one-way timeline gives NRI family members clarity, reducing stress and uncertainty.

System modules:

NRI User Module

- . create an account to use the services

- . Make a Booking

Select: Hospital Date & Time, type of help needed.

- . See companion profile before confirmation.

- . Receive real-time messages and updates through the Live Care Feed.

- . Make payments and view past bookings

Companion Module

- . register with ID proofs and background details.

- . Receive booking alerts from NRIs

- . Send real-time updates

- . Confirm that the service is successfully completed.

- . receive payment from users

Admin Module

- . Add, verify, and approve medical companions.

- . View NRI profiles and their booking history.

- . Monitor all appointment requests and assign suitable companions.

- . Access system logs, updates, and real-time companion activity if needed.

- . Complaint Tracking & Resolution

- . view all feedback submitted by NRIs

Impact:

- . Elderly parents receive hands-on support.

- . Student companions earn part-time income with social impact.

- . NRI children experience peace of mind, feeling “virtually present” despite distance.

Technology Stack:

frontend: React (Vite) + Tailwind CSS — fast and mobile-friendly UI.

Backend: Fast API — Fast, secure API and role-based access.

Database: PostgreSQL — reliable relational data storage.